

# WHAT

## ARE GOOD AND EVIL?

Smiling faces, kind voices, bright colors, warm feelings, and angels are associated with the concept of good. In contrast, evil is the dark side, linked to hatred, danger, and devils. Good and evil are opposites. Bringing happiness and pleasure, good is positive and valued highly, while evil is negative and harmful. Sometimes good and evil can deceive—if something appears too good to be true, it could be evil in disguise . . .

## DO YOU

**HAVE TO BE RELIGIOUS TO  
BELIEVE IN GOOD AND EVIL?**

Religious people believe that their faith teaches them to recognize what is good and that anything that denies or goes against those teachings is evil. However, people who do not think of themselves as religious also recognize a distinction between good and evil. An action that results in happiness and benefit to other people is good, while something that produces harm and misery is evil.

## WOULD

**EVERYONE AGREE ABOUT  
WHAT IS GOOD AND EVIL?**

Some things are universally considered good, such as caring for the sick or helping save lives. Similarly, almost everyone agrees that crimes such as murder and genocide are evil. But while we all find the idea of cannibalism, or human sacrifice, horrific today, people were not so squeamish in the past. Most of us eat meat, though some people believe that it is evil to kill animals. Ideas of good and evil are not necessarily fixed in one society, and they may change over time.

